

# Rent a Car Management System

## User Guide

**Version:** 1.0  
**Language:** English  
**Audience:** All system roles (Super Admin, Admin, Employee, Driver)

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## 1. Introduction

### 1.1 Purpose

The **Rent a Car Management System** is a back-office web application for running a car rental business. It helps you:

- Register customers and store identity documents
- Manage fleet, partners, and drivers
- Create and track rental bookings from inquiry to completion
- Record payments, security deposits, and damages
- Settle owner and broker accounts
- Monitor alerts, compliance, and financial performance

### 1.2 Who Uses the System

| Role        | Typical user                       |
|-------------|------------------------------------|
| Super Admin | Business owner or IT administrator |

|                 |                                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Admin (Manager) | Branch manager, operations manager         |
| Employee        | Front-desk staff, rental coordinators      |
| Driver          | Company drivers (limited read-only access) |

### 1.3 How to Open the System

1. Open a web browser (Chrome, Edge, or Safari recommended).
2. Go to your organisation's system URL (for example, your Vercel link or `http://localhost:3000` on the office PC).
3. Sign in with your email and password.
4. On a phone, use the **menu icon** (top bar) to open navigation.

**Note:** The system signs you out automatically after **10 minutes of inactivity**. You will see a message asking you to sign in again.

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## 2. Getting Started

### 2.1 First Login

Use the credentials provided by your administrator. Demo/training accounts (if seeded):

| Role        | Email                                                        | Password     |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Super Admin | <a href="mailto:admin@redknot.lk">admin@redknot.lk</a>       | Admin@123    |
| Admin       | <a href="mailto:manager@redknot.lk">manager@redknot.lk</a>   | Manager@123  |
| Employee    | <a href="mailto:employee@redknot.lk">employee@redknot.lk</a> | Employee@123 |
| Driver      | <a href="mailto:driver@redknot.lk">driver@redknot.lk</a>     | Driver@123   |

**Important:** Change default passwords in production.

### 2.2 Navigation

- **Desktop:** The sidebar on the left lists all modules you can access.
- **Mobile:** Tap the **menu** button to open the same list.
- **Header:** Theme toggle, notifications bell, help tour, and sign out.

### 2.3 Guided Tour

Click the **Help** button in the header to start the onboarding tour. It explains dashboard, customers, rentals, and notifications. You can restart the tour at any time.

### 2.4 Typical Daily Workflow

1. Check the **Dashboard** and **Notifications** for today's pickups, returns, and alerts.
2. Register or find the **Customer**.
3. Confirm **Vehicle** availability.
4. Create or update the **Rental** booking.
5. At handover: complete **Handover** and collect **Deposit** / **Advance** if needed.
6. At return: record **Ending Odometer**.
7. Record **Payments** until balance is zero.

8. **Complete** the rental.
  9. Process **Settlements** for owners/brokers when due.
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## 3. User Roles and Access

### 3.1 Super Admin

Full access to every module, including **Users** (create/edit/deactivate staff accounts).

### 3.2 Admin (Manager)

Same as Super Admin **except** cannot access the **Users** module.

### 3.3 Employee

Can manage day-to-day operations:

- View/create/edit **Customers** (cannot delete or blacklist)
- View **Vehicles, Owners, Brokers, Drivers** (read only)
- Create/edit **Rentals**, perform handover and return
- Create **Payments** (cannot edit/settle deposits)
- Create **Damages** and **Maintenance** records
- View **Notifications** and **Dashboard**

**Cannot access:** Settlements, Expenses, Reports, Audit Log, Settings, Users. Cannot cancel rentals.

### 3.4 Driver

Limited access:

- **Dashboard**
- **Rentals** (view only)
- **Notifications**

### 3.5 Permission Denied

If you open a page you are not allowed to use, the system redirects you to the Dashboard. Contact your Super Admin if you need additional access.

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## 4. Dashboard

The Dashboard is your daily command centre.

### 4.1 Upcoming Jobs

Shows today's handovers and tomorrow's pickup/return reminders. You can:

- Open the related rental
- Call the customer (phone link on mobile)
- Draft a reminder message (if AI is enabled)

### 4.2 Rental Status

Quick counts for: Inquiry, Quoted, Confirmed, Active, Returned, Completed, Cancelled, and Open Pipeline. Click a tile to open the filtered rental list.

### 4.3 Today's Operations

Includes tomorrow reminders, today's rentals, vehicles currently rented, available/reserved/maintenance counts, due-for-return, and overdue rentals.

### 4.4 Financial Summary

Today's revenue, month revenue, month expenses, net profit, outstanding balances, pending owner/broker payouts, and held security deposits.

### 4.5 Fleet Summary

Total vehicles and breakdown by status (Available, Reserved, Rented, Maintenance, Inactive).

### 4.6 Revenue vs Expenses Chart

A doughnut chart showing total revenue and expenses for the last six months, with net profit in the centre.

### 4.7 Alerts Panel

Summarises critical notifications (document expiry, overdue rentals, etc.).

### 4.8 Compliance Tiles

Shortcuts to vehicles with insurance, revenue licence, or emission certificate expiring or expired, and service due.

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## 5. Customers

**Menu:** Customers

**Permission:** `customers.view` (create/edit/delete/blacklist require higher permissions)

### 5.1 Customer List

- Search by name, NIC, phone, or customer code.
- Filter by status (Normal / Blacklisted).
- Open **Blacklisted Report** for a dedicated list and CSV export (Admin+).

### 5.2 Add New Customer

**Path:** Customers → Add Customer

**Required fields:**

- Full name
- NIC (Sri Lankan format: 12 digits or 9 digits + V)
- Phone
- Address

**Optional fields:**

- Passport, WhatsApp, emergency contact
- Driving licence number and expiry date
- Notes

**Photos & Documents (optional at registration):**

- **Customer Photo** — face photo for identification

- **Driving Licence — Front** — front of licence
- **Driving Licence — Back** — back of licence

Each upload is saved to the customer's **Documents** tab. Repeat customers can be found by NIC or phone — you do not need to re-upload every visit unless documents changed.

### 5.3 Customer Profile

Tabs on the profile:

| Tab               | Contents                                                 |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Personal Info     | Contact details, licence expiry badge, photo if uploaded |
| Documents         | All uploaded documents with view/edit/delete             |
| Rental History    | Past and current bookings                                |
| Payments          | Payment history                                          |
| Damages           | Linked damage records                                    |
| Blacklist History | Blacklist actions (if any)                               |

### 5.4 Driving Licence Expiry Warnings

If a licence is **expired** or **expiring within 30 days**, a red or yellow banner appears on the profile. Notifications are also created for staff.

**When a customer renews their licence:**

1. Physically verify the new licence.
2. Go to **Edit Customer** and update **Driving Licence Expiry** (and number if changed).
3. Optionally upload new front/back images under **Documents**.

### 5.5 Documents Tab

**Add Document:** Choose type (Customer Photo, Driving Licence, NIC, Address Verification, etc.).

For **Driving Licence** and **NIC**, upload **Front** and/or **Back** sides separately.

**Edit:** Click the pencil icon to update details or replace the image.

**View / Download:** Use buttons in the document row.

**Delete:** Removes the document record and file.

**Tip:** Use **Scan & Fill** (if AI is configured) to read document numbers and dates from a photo.

### 5.6 Blacklist a Customer

**Permission:** Admin or Super Admin

1. Open the customer profile.
2. Choose **Blacklist**.
3. Enter a reason (required) and optional notes.
4. Confirm.

Blacklisted customers show a warning on their profile. Depending on **Settings**, new bookings may be **blocked** or **warn only**.

**Remove blacklist:** Use **Remove from Blacklist** on the profile (Admin+).

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## 6. Vehicles

**Menu:** Vehicles

**Permission:** `vehicles.view` (create/edit/delete: Admin+)

### 6.1 Vehicle List

Shows registration number, make/model, status, ownership, and daily rate. Filter by status and search.

### 6.2 Add / Edit Vehicle

Key fields:

- Registration number, type (Car/SUV/Van/Other), make, model, year
- Ownership type: Company Owned, Personally Owned, Third Party Owned
- Linked owner (for partner vehicles)
- Daily / weekly / monthly rates, included km per day, extra km rate
- Current odometer reading
- Status

### 6.3 Vehicle Statuses

| Status      | Meaning                      |
|-------------|------------------------------|
| Available   | Ready to rent                |
| Reserved    | Assigned to upcoming booking |
| Rented      | Currently on rental          |
| Maintenance | In workshop                  |
| Unavailable | Temporarily not offered      |
| Inactive    | Retired from fleet           |

### 6.4 Vehicle Availability

**Path:** Vehicles → Availability

Search available vehicles for a date range before confirming a booking.

### 6.5 Vehicle Documents

**Path:** Vehicles → Documents

Track insurance, revenue licence, emission certificate, and registration. Expiring documents trigger dashboard and notification alerts.

Upload and manage documents from each vehicle's detail page.

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## 7. Vehicle Owners

**Menu:** Owners

**Permission:** `owners.view` (create/edit: Admin+)

Partner owners who lend vehicles to the business.

### 7.1 Owner Profile

- Contact and bank details for payouts
- Linked vehicles
- Settlement history with amounts and status

### 7.2 Settlements

When a rental on a partner-owned vehicle is **Completed**, an owner settlement is created automatically. Pay and download receipts from **Settlements** (see Section 13).

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## 8. Drivers

**Menu:** Drivers

**Permission:** `drivers.view` (create/edit: Admin+)

Company drivers used on **With Driver** rentals.

### 8.1 Driver Profile

- NIC, driving licence number and expiry (with expiry warnings)
- Daily driver payment rate
- Rental history, driver payments, and driver expenses

### 8.2 Driver Role Login

Users with the **Driver** role see only Dashboard, Rentals (view), and Notifications. They cannot edit bookings or record payments.

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## 9. Brokers

**Menu:** Brokers

**Permission:** `brokers.view` (create/edit: Admin+)

Referral agencies that send customers. Commissions are calculated when broker-linked rentals are completed.

### 9.1 Broker Profile

Contact details, commission history, and linked rentals.

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## 10. Rentals

**Menu:** Rentals (featured in sidebar)

**Permission:** `rentals.view`

### 10.1 Rental Status Flow

INQUIRY → QUOTED → CONFIRMED → ACTIVE → RETURNED → COMPLETED

↳ CANCELLED (from most pre-completion stages)

| Status    | Meaning                             |
|-----------|-------------------------------------|
| Inquiry   | Initial enquiry                     |
| Quoted    | Price sent to customer              |
| Confirmed | Booking confirmed, vehicle assigned |
| Active    | Vehicle handed over to customer     |
| Returned  | Vehicle back, odometer recorded     |
| Completed | Closed, settlements generated       |
| Cancelled | Booking cancelled                   |

## 10.2 Create a Rental

**Path:** Rentals → New Rental

1. Select **Customer** (search by name/NIC). Blacklist warning appears if applicable.
2. Choose **Rental type:** Self Drive or With Driver.
3. Set pickup and return **date and time**.
4. Assign **Vehicle** (availability is checked).
5. Optionally assign **Driver** and **Broker**.
6. Set rate plan (Daily / Weekly / Monthly / Custom) and charges.
7. Enter **starting odometer** (required before handover).
8. Set security deposit and advance payment if applicable.
9. Save.

Advance payment on create automatically records an **Advance** payment.

## 10.3 Edit a Rental

Allowed only while status is **Inquiry**, **Quoted**, or **Confirmed**. After handover, use status actions and odometer forms instead.

## 10.4 Confirm and Handover

1. **Mark as Quoted** — from Inquiry.
2. **Confirm Rental** — from Quoted (vehicle must be assigned).
3. **Handover** — on Confirmed rental: record handover date/time, fuel, condition, existing damage notes, customer acknowledgement.
  - Rental becomes **Active**.
  - Vehicle status becomes **Rented**.

## 10.5 Return and Mileage

On an **Active** rental:

1. Open the rental detail page.
2. Use **Ending Odometer** (inline form or dedicated page).
3. Enter ending odometer and return date/time.



4. Save — status becomes **Returned**.

The system calculates:

- Rental days (based on rental day boundary — default 7:00 PM to 7:00 PM)
- Included kilometres (included km × days)
- Extra km charge if odometer exceeds allowance
- Final total and balance

**Correct odometer:** Allowed after Returned/Completed if a mistake was made.

## 10.6 Complete a Rental

When status is **Returned** and financial processing is done:

1. Click **Complete Rental**.
2. Status becomes **Completed**.
3. Owner settlements and broker commissions are created automatically where applicable.

## 10.7 Cancel a Rental

**Permission:** Admin or Super Admin ( rentals.cancel )

Available from non-terminal statuses except Completed. Record reason when prompted.

## 10.8 Customer Receipt

When balance is **zero** and status is **Returned** or **Completed**, download the **Customer Receipt** PDF from the rental page.

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# 11. Payments and Deposits

**Menu:** Payments

**Permission:** payments.view (create: Employee+; edit/settle: Admin+)

## 11.1 Record a Payment

**From rental detail or Payments → Record Payment:**

- Payment type: Advance, Rental Payment, Final Payment, Damage Payment, Additional Charge, etc.
- Amount and method (Cash, Bank Transfer, Card, Online, Other)
- Reference number and notes

Payments update the rental **Total Paid** and **Balance**.

## 11.2 Security Deposits

**Collect deposit** (Employee+):

- One active held deposit per rental
- Recorded as Security Deposit payment type

**Settle deposit** (Admin+ only):

- Refund all or part to customer
- Retain portion for damages or charges
- Status: Held → Partially Refunded / Refunded / Forfeited

Employees can collect but **cannot settle** deposits.

### 11.3 Payments List

Ledger of all payments with filters. Click through to rental and customer.

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## 12. Damages

**Menu:** Damages

**Permission:** `damages.view` (create: Employee+; edit: Admin+)

### 12.1 Report Damage

Link to rental, vehicle, and customer. Record damage type, description, date, and customer charge amount.

### 12.2 Damage Status

REPORTED → ASSESSED → CHARGED → RESOLVED

Record **Damage Payment** from Payments module to update payment status (Unpaid / Partially Paid / Paid).

### 12.3 Locked Records

After damage payment is fully completed, editing may be restricted to preserve audit integrity.

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## 13. Settlements

**Menu:** Settlements

**Permission:** Admin or Super Admin

Three tabs:

### 13.1 Owner Settlements

Pending and paid amounts owed to vehicle owners. **Pay** records payout. Download or email **Owner Settlement Receipt** PDF.

### 13.2 Broker Commissions

Commission due to referral brokers. Record payment and download broker receipt.

### 13.3 Driver Payments

Read-only list; record driver payments from the **Driver** profile.

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## 14. Maintenance

**Menu:** Maintenance

**Permission:** `employees.view` create; all with view permission can see records

Log service history: oil change, full service, brakes, tyres, etc. Record cost, odometer, provider, and **next service date/km**.

**Service due alerts** appear on the maintenance page and in notifications (within 14 days or overdue).

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## 15. Expenses

**Menu:** Expenses

**Permission:** Admin or Super Admin

Track business expenses: fuel, insurance, repairs, driver payments, owner/broker payouts, parking, etc. Link to vehicle and/or rental where relevant.

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## 16. Reports

**Menu:** Reports

**Permission:** Admin or Super Admin

Date range filters apply to all tabs.

| Tab           | Purpose                                                |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Profitability | Revenue, costs, net profit by vehicle, month, or owner |
| Rentals       | Booking list with totals and balances                  |
| Payments      | Payment ledger                                         |
| Expenses      | Expense ledger                                         |
| Fleet         | Vehicle utilisation                                    |

**Export CSV** (Admin+ with export permission): use Export button on each tab.

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## 17. Notifications

**Menu:** Notifications (also bell icon in header)

### 17.1 Alert Types

- Vehicle document expired / expiring soon
- Customer driving licence expired / expiring soon
- Overdue rental (past return date)
- Service due or overdue
- Outstanding rental balance
- Pickup / return reminder for tomorrow

### 17.2 Actions

- **Sync Alerts** — refresh from current data
- **Mark Read / Mark All Read**
- **View** — opens related rental, customer, or module

Notifications auto-sync when you open the Dashboard.

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## 18. Audit Log

**Menu:** Audit Log  
**Permission:** Admin or Super Admin

Immutable trail of system actions: who did what, when, and on which record. Filter by entity type, action, or search text.

Useful for investigating changes, payments, and blacklist actions.

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## 19. Settings

**Menu:** Settings  
**Permission:** Admin or Super Admin (view/edit)

| Setting                   | Description                                          |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Company name              | Display name                                         |
| Rental day start time     | Default 19:00 (7 PM) — defines rental “day” boundary |
| Default included km       | Default km included per rental day (e.g. 200)        |
| Currency                  | LKR / Rs.                                            |
| Block blacklisted booking | Warn only vs block new rentals                       |
| Owner commission default  | Fixed Rs. per owner settlement                       |
| Broker commission default | Fixed Rs. per broker rental                          |

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## 20. Users (Super Admin)

**Menu:** Users  
**Permission:** Super Admin only

### 20.1 Create User

Email, password, name, phone, role, status (Active/Inactive).

### 20.2 Edit User

Update details or reset password. Cannot deactivate yourself or the last active Super Admin.

### 20.3 Roles

Assign: Super Admin, Admin, Employee, or Driver.

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## 21. Appendix

### 21.1 Glossary

| Term     | Definition                                       |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Handover | Vehicle given to customer; rental becomes Active |

|                  |                                                           |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Return           | Vehicle back; ending odometer recorded                    |
| Settlement       | Payment to vehicle owner or broker after completed rental |
| Security deposit | Refundable hold collected at handover                     |
| Extra km         | Charge when driven distance exceeds included allowance    |
| Open pipeline    | Rentals from Inquiry through Returned (not yet Completed) |

## 21.2 Rental Day Boundary

By default, one rental “day” runs from **7:00 PM to 7:00 PM** (configurable in Settings). Pickup and return times affect day count.

## 21.3 Included Kilometres

Default **200 km per rental day** unless overridden on the vehicle or rental. Extra distance billed at the vehicle’s extra km rate.

## 21.4 File Uploads

- Accepted formats: JPG, PNG, WEBP, and common image types
- Large photos are compressed automatically
- On cloud hosting (e.g. Vercel), uploaded files may not persist permanently — plan cloud storage for long-term production use

## 21.5 Session and Security

- **Idle timeout:** 10 minutes without activity
- **Maximum session:** 8 hours
- Always sign out on shared computers
- Use strong passwords; Super Admin should rotate default seed passwords

## 21.6 Mobile Usage

The system works in a mobile browser. Use the menu icon for navigation. Tap phone numbers to call customers from upcoming jobs.

## 21.7 Troubleshooting

| Problem                 | What to try                                                  |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cannot sign in          | Check email/password; ask admin to confirm account is Active |
| Signed out unexpectedly | Idle timeout — sign in again                                 |
| Page not allowed        | Your role lacks permission — contact Super Admin             |
| Document upload failed  | Use JPG/PNG; file under 30 MB; try again                     |
| Balance will not clear  | Record payments until balance shows zero                     |
| Customer blacklisted    | Remove blacklist or change Settings if blocking bookings     |

## 21.8 Support Checklist for Administrators

1. Confirm user role and status in **Users**.
2. Check **Settings** for business rules.
3. Review **Audit Log** for recent changes.
4. Run **Sync Alerts** on Notifications.
5. Verify database and environment configuration (technical — see deployment documentation).

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## End of User Guide

*Rent a Car Management System — User Guide v1.0*